

Chapter 11 – Updating Tax Registration

11.1 Introduction

After obtaining a **Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)**, a taxpayer may need to update their **tax registration** due to changes in business activities, tax obligations, or registration status. The Inland Revenue Department (IRD) allows registered taxpayers to update their tax registration electronically through the **IRD e-Services Portal**.

Updating tax registration ensures that the taxpayer's records accurately reflect their current tax obligations and helps maintain compliance with Sri Lankan tax laws. Taxpayers should update their registration promptly whenever changes occur that affect the taxes for which they are registered.

11.2 What is Tax Registration Updating?

Tax registration updating is the process of modifying the tax types or tax-related information already registered under a taxpayer's TIN.

This process does **not** create a new TIN. Instead, it updates the taxpayer's existing registration to reflect changes such as:

- Changes in business status.
- Changes in taxable activities.
- Updates to VAT project information.
- Changes affecting Income Tax, Corporate Income Tax (CIT), Withholding Tax (WHT), or other registered tax types.

These updates can be submitted online through the IRD e-Services Portal.

11.3 When Should Tax Registration Be Updated?

A taxpayer should submit a tax registration update whenever there are changes affecting their registered tax information.

Examples include:

- Commencing or ceasing taxable business activities.

- Changes to business operations.
- Changes in VAT-related projects.
- Changes in tax registration status.
- Any other changes requiring updates to existing tax registrations.

Keeping tax registration current helps ensure that tax records remain accurate and up to date.

11.4 Accessing the Tax Registration Update Service

To update tax registration online:

1. Visit the Inland Revenue Department website.
2. Log in to the **IRD e-Services Portal**.
3. Navigate to:

Taxpayer Registration → Change Tax Type Detail Request

The system displays the list of tax types currently registered under the taxpayer's profile.

11.5 Viewing Registered Tax Types

Once the **Change Tax Type Detail Request** page is opened, taxpayers can view all tax types currently registered under their TIN.

Depending on the taxpayer's profile, examples may include:

- Corporate Income Tax (CIT)
- Withholding Tax (WHT)
- Value Added Tax (VAT)
- Other applicable tax types

The taxpayer should select the relevant tax type that requires updating.

11.6 Updating Corporate Income Tax (CIT)

To update **Corporate Income Tax (CIT)** registration:

1. Select **CIT** from the registered tax types.
2. Review the existing registration details.
3. Update the registration status where necessary.
4. Save the changes.

The updated information is included in the application submitted to the Inland Revenue Department for review.

11.7 Updating Withholding Tax (WHT)

Taxpayers registered for **Withholding Tax (WHT)** may update their registration when their withholding obligations change.

The process includes:

1. Selecting **WHT**.
2. Updating the relevant registration information.
3. Saving the updated details.

The IRD reviews the request before updating the taxpayer's registration records.

11.8 Updating Value Added Tax (VAT)

Taxpayers registered for **Value Added Tax (VAT)** may update information relating to VAT registration.

The system allows updates to:

- VAT registration information.
- Project details.
- Registration status.

Where applicable, taxpayers may also request extensions relating to existing VAT projects.

11.9 Updating VAT Projects

Where VAT registration is associated with projects, taxpayers may manage project information through the portal.

Available options include:

Extending Existing Projects

The taxpayer may:

1. Select the existing project.
2. Tick the **Request for Extension** option.
3. Save the request.

Adding New Projects

To register a new project:

1. Select **Add Project**.
2. Enter the project information.
3. Provide the project address.
4. Save the project details.

The newly added project becomes part of the tax registration update request.

11.10 Supporting Documents

Where required, taxpayers must upload documents supporting the requested changes.

The process includes:

1. Selecting the appropriate **Document Type**.
2. Selecting the relevant **Sub-Document Type**.
3. Uploading the supporting document.
4. Confirming that the uploaded document appears in the application.

If an incorrect document is uploaded, it may be removed and replaced before submission.

11.11 Reviewing the Application

Before submission, the system displays a summary of the application.

Taxpayers should carefully review:

- Updated tax registration information.
- Supporting documents.
- Registration status.
- Project information (where applicable).

Corrections should be made before proceeding to the declaration stage.

11.12 Declaration

Before submitting the request, the taxpayer must complete the declaration by providing:

- Name
- Designation
- Contact Number

By submitting the declaration, the taxpayer confirms that all information provided is true, accurate, and complete.

11.13 Submission and Acknowledgement

After successful submission:

- The Inland Revenue Department receives the application.
- An acknowledgement page is generated.
- The taxpayer may print the acknowledgement for future reference.

The acknowledgement confirms that the request has been successfully submitted for processing.

11.14 Common Reasons for Updating Tax Registration

Taxpayers commonly update their tax registration when:

- Business activities change.
- VAT projects are extended.
- New VAT projects commence.
- Registration status changes.
- Tax obligations change.
- Additional supporting documents need to be submitted.

Timely updates help maintain accurate tax records and reduce administrative issues.

11.15 Best Practices

To ensure efficient processing, taxpayers should:

- Review all information before submission.
- Upload clear and complete supporting documents.
- Select the correct tax type for updating.
- Keep contact information up to date.
- Retain the acknowledgement after submission.
- Respond promptly if the IRD requests additional information.

These practices help avoid delays and facilitate accurate processing of tax registration updates.

11.16 Key Points

- Updating tax registration allows taxpayers to modify information relating to their existing tax registrations.
- Updates are completed through the **Taxpayer Registration → Change Tax Type Detail Request** service in the IRD e-Services Portal.
- Taxpayers may update **Corporate Income Tax (CIT)**, **Withholding Tax (WHT)**, **VAT**, and related project information.
- Supporting documents should be uploaded where required.
- Every application must be reviewed, declared, and submitted through the portal.
- A successful submission generates an acknowledgement that should be retained for future reference.